

led a revitalized 70,000-strong force out of Washington in pursuit of Lee.



Battle of South Mountain

On September 14, Confederate troops defended the mountain passes against superior Union forces, buying valuable time for Lee to concentrate his army.

“The [soldiers] looked to me **not made of flesh** and blood **but stone and iron.**”

MARYLAND'S ELIZABETH K. HOWARD DESCRIBING THE SOUTHERNERS,
SEPTEMBER 1862